To Samaldas's probing questions about the nature of Indian companies, Krishna Aiyangar said he was strongly against taking European partners. Though he was 'not against individual Europeans', he submitted that management ought to remain with Indians though Europeans could be employed. To Krishna Aiyangar this was 'a purely national standpoint'. The final exchange quite summed up the two contending positions. It is tempting to think of Samaldas as playing the devil's advocate but he does seem to have taken his job rather seriously.

> Q.: Take Scindia Navigation Company. It had competition. It came to some sort of agreement with older companies and it is working all right without any assistance from Government. This shows that with capable management, efficient capital and experienced men any Shipping Company could get on. There is no reason why new companies should cut their way. It is reasonable to expect that no shipping business would welcome newcomers without cutting their rates. It all depends upon ability and worth of new concerns. History simply repeats itself here.
>
> A.: You are advocating free trade. But there are nations which advocate protection also. I have spoken from experience only.

The committee's line of argument was that an established company would naturally put up an opposition. 'It is unreasonable to expect that any established business would open its arms and welcome a new-comer that is going to take its business away; but if there is a fight and if the new company proves its worth, history repeats itself; and the new company would be taken in.'[37] To which Krishna Aiyangar retorted that he only blamed the government for not supporting it and not BI: 'It is the old, old history of Free Trade *versus* Protection that you are arguing. Yet, we know the Governments of very many nations, industrially highly advanced, protecting their infant national industries in their competition with Foreign Companies.'[38]

Krishna Aiyangar strongly advocated Indian shipping. In defining what would count as Indian, he had no objection to European expertise being used for running the ships. Management and ownership were the key and these, he argued, should be in Indian hands. Asked if there would not be competition among Indian companies, he replied that he welcomed it.